

Activity 1. Recognizing writing style in different contexts.

Objective: Identify the characteristics of indirect writing style in different types of text.

Features of indirect style:

- Use of ambiguity (it seems that, it appears that...)
- Avoidance of confrontation (softening language)
- Use of passive voice
- Complex sentences and subordinate clauses
- Use of modals and conditionals (Might, could, may, would)

Instructions: Read the following excerpts carefully. Identify which sentences are written in an indirect style. **Highlight or underline the characteristics of indirect style.** Be prepared to explain your answers.

Text 1: Professional e-mail.

Excerpt A

Dear Ms. Thompson, you submitted the report late, and this caused delays in the project. Please make sure this does not happen again.

Excerpt B

Dear Ms. Thompson, it appears that the report may not have been submitted within the expected timeframe, which seems to have caused some delays in the project. It would be greatly appreciated if future submissions could be completed according to the agreed schedule.

Text 2: Informal conversation.

Excerpt A

You didn't tell me about the change in plans, so I missed the meeting.

Excerpt B

I'm not sure if I was informed about the change in plans, as I seem to have missed the meeting. Maybe there was a misunderstanding somewhere.

Text 3: Academic extract.

Excerpt A

The experiment failed because the researchers did not control the variables properly.

Excerpt B

It could be suggested that the outcome of the experiment was influenced by variables that may not have been fully controlled, which might have affected the final results.

Activity 2. Rewrite the following direct sentences using an indirect style:

1. You made several mistakes in the report.

2. The team did not follow the instructions.

3. Your proposal is unclear.

4. The results are wrong.

Make sure to include: At least one modal verb, one passive voice construction and a complex sentence.

Activity 3. Writing a story using indirect style

Instructions: Write a short anecdote (180-250 words) about.

- A recent personal experience.
- A historical event.
- A fictional situation.

You must tell the story indirectly. Avoid direct blame or strong statements.

Remember to include:

- At least three softening expressions.
- At least two passive voice sentences.
- At least three modal verbs.
- At least one complex sentence.

Here are some expressions for indirect style:

- **Ambiguity:** It seems that, it appears that, it could be suggested that...
- **Avoiding confrontation:** It may be possible that, it is often believe that...
- **Passive voice:** It was reported that, it has been suggested that...

Example of the writing:

It seems that something unusual may have happened during last Friday's presentation. There was talk that some important slides had been removed from the final version, although it is not entirely clear how this occurred.

It might be argued that certain technical issues could have contributed to the confusion. Some might say that better preparation would have prevented the situation; however, it appears that unexpected circumstances were involved.

In the end, it was decided that the presentation would be rescheduled, which may have been the most reasonable solution.

Activity 3. Writing a story using indirect style.